Accordingly, they mounted at midnight and went to a distant orchard. In the meantime, Bābā Sairāmī kept a watch from the roof of a house. He came downstairs after almost half a day and said, ‘Commandant Yūsuf is coming.’

Babur’s eyes rolled with fear. ‘Find out,’ Babur said, adding, ‘Whether he comes because he knows about me.’

Bābā Sairāmī spoke to Yūsuf subsequently. He returned and said, ‘He says he met a foot soldier at the Gate of Akhsī who said to him, “The Padishah is in such a place,” and that he told no one.’

Babur replied without thinking much and said, ‘How does it strike you?’

Then he replied, ‘They are all your servants, you must go. What else can you do? They will make you, their ruler.’

Babur replied, ‘After such rebellion and fighting with what confidence could I go?’

While they were already in discussion, Yūsuf appeared at once. He knelt before Babur and said, ‘Why should it be hidden? Sulṭān Aḥmad Taṃbal has no news of you, but Shaikh Bāyazīd has, and he sent me here.’

Babur became miserable on hearing this. With this circumstance in mind, he has written, ‘For well is it understood that nothing in the world is worse than fear for one’s life.’

‘Tell the truth!’ Babur said softly, ‘If the affair is likely to get worse, I will make ablution.’

Although Yūsuf had taken an oath to not attack, Babur wasn’t ready to trust him entirely. But Babur was aware of his own helplessness. He went to a corner of the garden, muttering, ‘If a man lives a hundred years or a thousand years, at the last nothing . . .’

Notes from Annette Beveridge’s translation of the *Baburnama*:[*]

Friends are likely to have rescued Bābur from his dangerous isolation. His presence in Karnān was known both in Ghawā and in Akhsī; Muḥ. Bāqir Beg was at hand (f. 117); some of those he had dropped in his flight would follow him when their horses had had rest; Jahāngīr was somewhere north of the river with the half of Bābur’s former force (f. 112); The Khāns, with their long-extended line of march, may have been on the main road through or near Karnān. If Yūsuf took Bābur as a prisoner along the Akhsī road, there were these various chances of his meeting friends. (. . .)